

Superintendent Pay in Context

DRAFT

Andover, CT · Dr. Valerie Bruneau and her Connecticut peers · FY 2025–26

A personal report by Scott Sauyet · scott@sauyet.com · Not an official town document

Data was assembled by crawling 45 small Connecticut town and school district websites, OCR'ing scanned PDF contracts, manually reviewing contracts shared as Google Drive links, incorporating findings from an online research-agent collaboration, and obtaining contracts directly from town clerks under CGS § 10-244c records requests. Of the 45 peer districts identified as comparable to Andover, 38 peer districts (30 unique superintendent contracts) have contract data in hand; two HS-only reference contracts — for Amity Regional School District No. 5 (Byars, the regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Bethany, Orange, Woodbridge) and Northwestern Region 7 (LePage, the regional 7-12 supe shared by Barkhamsted, Colebrook, New Hartford, Norfolk) — are also included in the broadest view for context. For the remaining 6 peer districts a thorough search of public sites and clerk outreach have not yet produced the current contract. All figures are "cash compensation" — the salary line plus any board-paid 403(b) annuity, longevity bonus, fixed transportation allowance, and other lump sums. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are excluded. Because Connecticut superintendent contracts vary widely in work effort — from 12-hour-per-week part-time positions to full-time K-12 regional superintendents — all dollar figures are normalized to a hypothetical 1.0-FTE-equivalent (260-day work year) for apples-to-apples comparison. Andover's portion of Dr. Bruneau's compensation is reported separately so readers can see both what Andover pays and what her market-rate compensation works out to.

INTRODUCTION

Overview

Dr. Valerie Bruneau is Andover's Superintendent of Schools. She is also Scotland's, under a separate Scotland contract that has now been located (its most recent vintage on file is 2021-2024). Her time is split 60/40 between the two K-6 districts — 0.6 FTE at Andover and 0.4 FTE at Scotland — a structure that the Andover and Scotland contracts each state explicitly. Andover's contract pays her \$90,000 cash plus a \$10,000 mandatory 403(b) deferral for the 2025–26 school year, for an Andover-paid total of \$100,000. Treating that as the Andover-share of a single full-time job, her implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent compensation is **\$166,667**.

This report sets that figure in context by comparing it to every other Connecticut superintendent contract we could find for the 45 small towns identified as peers — towns of similar size, similar grade-level **DRAFT**, and similar regional profile. The contracts vary in age and scope, so the report presents three different cuts of the data, each with different inclusion rules. Andover sits near the bottom in all three.

METHODOLOGY

A note on methodology before the numbers

Two methodological choices shape every table that follows. Both deserve a line of explanation before the numbers appear.

FTE-equivalent, not raw salary. Andover is a small K-6 district that shares its superintendent with Scotland. Other towns in the peer set are also small enough to share — Region 4 (Chester, Deep River, Essex/Centerbrook) has one K-12 superintendent across four boards; ER9 (Easton, Redding, Region 9) has one across three. Comparing Andover's \$100,000 Andover-paid amount to Region 4's per-town share isn't apples-to-apples because Andover is paying for 60% of a person's time while Region 4 districts are each paying for 25% of a different person's time. The FTE-equivalent normalization expresses each contract as "what would this superintendent earn if working a full 260-day work year at this district's pay rate." It is the metric that makes contracts comparable across different sharing arrangements.

By contract, not by district. When three boards sign one joint contract (McKinnon for ER9; White for Region 4), it is one observation, not three. The tables in this report dedupe by contract for joint cases (one row for McKinnon, listing Easton/Redding; one for White, listing Centerbrook/Chester/Deep River). Where two districts share a superintendent under *separate* contracts, each is counted as its own observation. Bruneau's Andover and Scotland contracts are the canonical example: she appears under Andover (2025-26 contract) and again under Scotland (2021-22, the latest Scotland contract located).

ANDOVER'S CONTRACT

Part 1 — Dr. Bruneau's contract

The current Andover contract runs from July 1, 2023 through June 30, 2026. Section 2 explicitly defines the role as a 0.60 FTE position. Section 4 defines "annual base salary" as the sum of (a) a cash component paid biweekly and (b) a \$10,000 mandatory deferral into a 403(b) annuity. The three contract-year figures are:

Andover's portion of Dr. Bruneau's compensation ✓ *Confirmed from contract, Section 4*

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Contract year	Cash component	403(b) deferral	Andover-paid total
2023–24	\$80,000	\$10,000	\$90,000
2024–25	\$85,000	\$10,000	\$95,000
2025–26	\$90,000	\$10,000	\$100,000

Notes: Source: [Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf), Section 4 (BASE SALARY). The 403(b) amount is technically a “salary reduction agreement” — the Superintendent elects to defer \$10,000 of her base salary into a tax-sheltered annuity — but it is part of the total compensation the Board is obligated to provide, and the Board reports the full \$90K+\$10K total to the Connecticut State Teachers’ Retirement System.

What “\$166,667” includes. The comparison tables in Part 3 sum, for every contract, the same cash items: the salary cash component plus the board-paid or board-provided 403(b) annuity plus any longevity bonus plus any fixed transportation allowance. For Bruneau in 2025–26 that is \$90,000 cash + \$10,000 annuity = \$100,000 — both lines included, not just the salary cash. Divided by Andover’s 0.6 FTE share gives the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate of \$166,667 used in every comparison below. Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage reimbursements are *not* included for any contract — see the Methodology italic at the top of the report. The treatment is uniform: if a peer contract has its own annuity, it is added in the same way.

The 2026–2029 successor contract — referenced in the FY26/FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — proposes a \$100,000 cash component for FY 2026–27, plus a \$15,000 annuity (up from \$10,000). Part 4 returns to that figure and shows where it would land in the current peer distribution.

PEER COHORT

Part 2 — The peer cohort

The original peer list contained 45 small Connecticut towns selected for similarity to Andover (small enrollment, small budget, K-6 or K-8 elementary structure, sometimes regional secondary). After excluding Norwich (which is structurally very different — much larger, much more urban), the working comparison set is 44 districts.

Of those 44, contract data is available for **30 unique peer-district superintendent contracts covering 38 peer districts** (the cohort grew by 6 new contracts plus 2 successor refreshes in this round, a **DRAFT** §10-244c records requests to town clerks). Two HS-only reference contracts are also tracked: Amity Region 5 (Byars), the regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Bethany, Orange, and Woodbridge; and Northwestern Region 7 (LePage), the regional 7-12 supe shared by peer towns Barkhamsted, Colebrook, New Hartford, and Norfolk. Only **6 peer districts remain pending**:

- **2 districts where the current supe is documented but the contract is not yet retrieved.** Mansfield/Storrs (Dr. Candace Morell, appointed 5/21/2025, started 7/1/2025); Woodbridge (K-6 supe unknown, new recruiting in progress).
- **4 districts** where a thorough search of public sites and initial clerk outreach has not yet produced a current contract: Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Union. All four are very small EASTCONN-region districts where part-time superintendent arrangements are common but the supe's name and tenure are not always established with certainty.

In the round between this report and the previous one, **all six remaining districts from the K-6/K-8 main cohort that the previous report flagged as “recent personnel change documented but contract not yet retrieved”** — Marlborough, Orange, Sherman, Winsted, Woodstock, plus Bethany — have **all** now been retrieved. The pattern of clerk responses has been very consistent: a polite §10-244c records request emailed to a town clerk typically yields the contract within days. Two cohorts of stale data have also been refreshed in this round: Columbia (Fearon 2017-2018, the oldest entry in the dataset → Wilson 2024-2028) and Barkhamsted (Agostine 2023-2026 → Sacharko 2025-2028 — a mid-term supe transition the prior data hadn't captured).

CGS § 10-244c (Public Act 17-2) directs town clerks to post superintendent contracts on the town website, but compliance is uneven. Requesting a copy from the town clerk — including via the state's Freedom of Information process — turned out to be highly effective.

The full list of pending districts appears in Sources at the end.

COMPARISON

Part 3 — Three views of the comparison

The same underlying data supports three different views, each with different inclusion rules. Each makes a slightly different argument; the picture changes from view to view but Andover's position never improves.

View 1 — All contracts we can find, latest known

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The most inclusive view. Includes every contract whose dollar figure we have a real observation for, regardless of when it was signed. Five contracts in this view are stale (data is from 2017–18, 2021–22, or 2023–24 because no newer contract was located), two — the LePage Region 7 contract and the Byars Amity Region 5 contract — cover HS-only roles, two — the Brady-Shanley Region 1 contract and the White Region 4 contract — are joint K-12 regional contracts, and one — the Skarzynski Chaplin contract — is a joint K-12 with Region 11. Stale rows are flagged with [A](#).

Andover ranks **26th of 31**. Mean: \$200,860. Median: \$193,250.

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
				DRAFT
1	Dr. Jason McKinnon	2025–26	Easton, Redding	\$310,408
2	Brian J. White	2023–24	Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River	\$265,577
3	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
4	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
5	Melony M. Brady-Shanley	2025–26	Falls Village, Kent, Lakeville, North Canaan, Sharon, West Cornwall	\$245,610
6	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
7	Dr. Jennifer Byars †	2025–26	Amity Region 5 (Bethany/Orange/Woodbridge)	\$243,762
8	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
9	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
10	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
11	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
12	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
13	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
14	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
15	Steven LePage †	2023–24 [△]	Region 7 (Barkhamsted/Colebrook/New Hartford/Norfolk HS)	\$195,000
16	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
17	Dr. Jack Zmary	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
18	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
19	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
20	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
21	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
22	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
23	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167

Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
				DRAFT
24	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
25	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
26	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
27	Philip “Phil” Stevens	2023–24 [△]	West Willington	\$164,591
28	Steven Rioux	2021–22 [△]	Canterbury	\$153,200
29	Donna P. Leake	2021–22 [△]	Eastford	\$146,866
30	Valerie Bruneau	2021–22 [△]	Scotland	\$143,048
31	Andrew Skarzynski (Chaplin) [‡]	2025–26	Chaplin	\$140,000

Notes: [△] flags contracts whose dollar figure is from before 2024–25. ⁺ Steven LePage’s Region 7 contract and Dr. Jennifer Byars’ Amity Region 5 contract both cover high-school-only roles (grades 7–12), a meaningfully different scope from the elementary-only superintendents that dominate this list — both are excluded from Views 2 and 3 below. Both are reference contracts representing 7-12 supervision that is paid by member towns through a regional district. [‡] Andrew Skarzynski’s Chaplin contract is a joint K-12 agreement covering Chaplin elementary (K-6) and Region 11 (grades 7–12 serving Chaplin/Hampton/Scotland) under a single Central Office Committee; the FTE-equivalent shown is the superintendent’s full compensation, not Chaplin’s share. Skarzynski also serves Hampton K-8 under a separate part-time contract (rank 23 above). The Sterling, CT contract (Friend 2026-2029) is excluded from this view because it is future-dated; it appears separately in the FY27 forward-looking section. The Fearon Columbia stale row is dropped: a current Wilson 2024-2028 contract supersedes it.

View 2 — K-6 / K-8 only, latest known

Filters out the K-12 regional superintendent contracts (McKinnon ER9, White Region 4, Brady-Shanley Region 1, Skarzynski Chaplin) and the two HS-only reference contracts (LePage Region 7, Byars Amity Region 5), leaving only contracts whose scope is comparable to Andover’s K-6 role. This is the cohort that most directly matches Dr. Bruneau’s role.

Andover ranks **21st of 25**. Mean: \$193,052. Median: \$190,000. Andover is **–12% below the median** (\$166,667 vs \$190,000).

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
				DRAFT
1	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
2	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
3	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
4	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
5	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
6	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
7	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
8	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
9	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
10	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
11	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
12	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
13	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
14	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
15	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
16	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
17	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
18	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167
19	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
20	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
21	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667
22	Philip “Phil” Stevens	2023–24 A	West Willington	\$164,591
23	Steven Rioux	2021–22 A	Canterbury	\$153,200
24	Donna P. Leake	2021–22 A	Eastford	\$146,866
25	Valerie Bruneau	2021–22 A	Scotland	\$143,048

Notes: Filter: --latest-known --scope k-6,k-8 . The four contracts ranked below Andov " stale. Rioux's Canterbury contract expired June 2023, Leake's Eastford expired June 2024, and Bruneau's Scotland contract is the 2021-22 year-1 figure from her 2021-2024 contract (years 2-3 were negotiated but not in our file, and no successor contract has been located) — so the current Canterbury, Eastford, and Scotland rates are almost certainly higher than the stale figures shown. Stevens' West Willington contract is still running through June 2026 but the listed figure is year-1 (2023–24); years 2 and 3 likely include step-ups. The previously-stale Fearon Columbia row at \$146,660 has been **replaced** by the current Wilson contract at \$202,400 — the largest single-row data refresh in the dataset to date. **Note Skarzynski appears twice in the broader Views 1 and 2** — once for his Chaplin/R11 joint contract (rank 31 in View 1) and once for the Hampton part-time arrangement (rank 23 in View 1 / rank 18 in View 2).

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View 3 — K-6 / K-8 only, current contracts only (strict)

The most apples-to-apples view: K-6/K-8 scope, contract data from 2024–25 or later, no stale figures. This eliminates uncertainty about whether older contracts have been renegotiated since.

Andover ranks **21st of 21** — last. Mean: \$200,885. Median: \$193,250. Andover is **–14% below the median**.

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
2	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
3	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
4	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
5	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
6	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
7	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
8	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
9	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
10	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
11	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
12	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
13	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
14	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
15	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
16	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
17	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
18	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167
19	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
20	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
21	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover	\$166,667

Notes: Filter: --scope k-6,k-8 (the default strict rule). **No K-6/K-8 peer with a current** **DRAFT** **pays less than Andover.** The next-lowest peer — Norfolk at \$173,750 — pays 4% more than Andover does. Scotland is not in this table because Bruneau’s Scotland contract that we have is stale (2021–22); a current Scotland contract would be expected to enter at the same \$166,667 FTE-equivalent as Andover, since the two are proportional sides of the same 1.0 FTE. The cohort has now more than doubled from the first iteration of this report (10 peers in mid-June, 15 after the first §10-244c outreach round, **21 now**), and the headline finding has held: **Andover is alone at the bottom, with zero peers below.** The next-lowest current K-6/K-8 peer is Norfolk at \$173,750 (4% above Andover); the median is now \$193,250 (15.9% above Andover); the mean is \$200,885 (20.5% above Andover).

FY 2026–27

Part 4 — The FY 2026–27 proposal

The 2023–2026 Andover contract expires June 30, 2026. The successor contract — referenced in the FY26/FY27 town budget approved February 11, 2026 — bumps the cash component from \$90,000 to \$100,000 for FY 2026–27 (a +11.1% increase on the cash component) and bumps the 403(b) deferral from \$10,000 to \$15,000.

The combined effect: Andover’s payment goes from \$100,000 to \$115,000 (+15%). At the same 0.6 FTE share, the implied 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate goes from \$166,667 to \$191,667.

Where the FY27 proposal would place Andover against current peer rates

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Rank	Superintendent	Year	District(s)	FTE-equiv
1	Erika F. Sacharko	2025–26	Barkhamsted	\$265,141
2	Dr. Patricia Cosentino	2025–26	Sherman	\$249,163
3	Dr. Vincent (Vince) Scarpetti	2025–26	Orange	\$244,337
4	Dr. Thomas Baird	2025–26	Hebron	\$223,736
5	Dr. Holly B. Hageman	2025–26	Marlborough	\$222,222
6	Immacolata Canelli	2024–25	East Hartland	\$208,880
7	Barbara Wilson	2025–26	Columbia	\$202,400
8	Scott Feder	2025–26	Voluntown	\$200,000
9	Brian Hendrickson	2025–26	Salem	\$197,699
10	Robert Gilbert	2025–26	Colebrook	\$195,620
11	Jeffrey F. Sousa	2025–26	New Hartford	\$193,250
12	Dr. Jack Zamar	2025–26	Bozrah	\$193,063
—	Andover (FY 2026–27 proposed)	2026–27	Andover	\$191,667
13	Christopher Roche	2025–26	Woodstock	\$190,000
14	Dr. Julie Luby	2025–26	Winsted	\$189,100
15	Michele Raynor	2025–26	Brooklyn	\$185,000
16	Kai Byrd	2024–25	Bethany	\$184,642
17	Dr. Roy Seitsinger	2025–26	Preston	\$179,307
18	Andrew Skarzynski (Hampton)	2025–26	Hampton	\$179,167
19	William Hull	2025–26	Baltic (Sprague)	\$175,443
20	Mary Beth Iacobelli	2024–25	Norfolk	\$173,750
21	Valerie Bruneau	2025–26	Andover (current FY26)	\$166,667

Notes: This is an apples-to-not-quite-apples comparison. The Andover row is FY 2026–27. The peer rows are mostly FY 2025–26. Almost all of those peer contracts will themselves step up in FY 2026–27 — and Andover’s relative position will move down again once those FY27 peer figures are negotiated and published. So this table is best read as “where the FY27 Andover number would sit *if peer pay froze*”, which it won’t. The FY27 row is interpolated between Zamarly (\$193,063) and Roche (\$190,000) under that “frozen peer” assumption. The +\$10K cash bump reflects a contractual move from –14% below the current-cohort median to roughly –0.8% below it, in a cohort that itself will move up before FY27 begins. The 403(b) annuity bump from \$10K to \$15K — less remarked upon — is a structural change worth noting separately.

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The successor contract has not yet been published in full as of this report’s compilation date. When it is, the FY28 and FY29 figures (cash components of \$105K and \$110K respectively, per the budget document, plus the \$15K annuity) can be added.

Summary table

Question	Answer
What does Andover pay Dr. Bruneau for FY 2025–26?	\$90,000 cash + \$10,000 403(b) = \$100,000 total
What's the 1.0-FTE-equivalent rate that implies?	\$166,667 (Andover's share is 60% of a full-time position)
Where does that rank against peer Connecticut superintendents?	Bottom 6 of 31 in the broadest view; last of 21 in the strictest
How far below the K-6/K-8 peer median is Andover?	\$23,333 (–12%) below the latest-known median of \$190,000; \$26,583 (–14%) below the strict median of \$193,250
Does any K-6/K-8 peer with a 2024-or-newer contract pay less?	No. Andover is at the bottom of every current-data peer cohort.
What would FY 2026–27 do to Andover's ranking against current peer rates?	Move from last of 21 to about rank 13 of 21 (≈0.8% below current median). Peer rates will themselves rise in FY27, so the actual FY27-vs-FY27 picture will likely shift back toward the current gap.
What is "cash compensation" in this report?	Base salary + board-contributed 403(b) + longevity bonuses + fixed transportation allowances
What's excluded?	Health insurance value, life insurance face amount, LTD, IRS-rate mileage, sick-day buyback

ANALYSIS

Key Observations

Andover's superintendent rate is unambiguously below peer rates across every cut of the data we can run. The bottom-of-the-distribution finding is not an artifact of one inclusion rule. Whether you use the broadest view (every contract we can find, including stale ones, all scopes) or the strictest (K-6/K-8 only, no stale data), Andover sits at or near the bottom.

The strict K-6/K-8 view is the cleanest comparison. It eliminates two confounders — scope mismatch (K-12 regional supes earn more because their role is bigger) and stale data (older contracts almost certainly have step-ups not visible from the dollar figures we have). In that view, Andover is rank 21 of 21 — last —

and no K-6/K-8 peer with a current contract pays less than Andover does. The cohort has more than doubled since the first iteration of this report (10 → 15 → 21) and the finding has held at each step: even if the contract added has paid more than Andover, not less. **DRAFT**

The contracts ranked below Andover in the broader views are likely understated. Canterbury (Rioux, \$153,200) is from a 2020–2023 contract that expired three years ago; Eastford (Leake, \$146,866) from a 2021–2024 contract that expired two years ago; Scotland (Bruneau, \$143,048) is the year-1 figure of a 2021–2024 contract that expired two years ago. The current rates in these districts are presumably higher than the stale figures after intervening step-ups. The same logic applies to West Willington (Stevens). Chaplin (Skarzynski, \$140,000), at the very bottom of View 1, is a current 2024–2027 contract but reflects only the contractual minimum for year 2; the negotiated amount could be higher. If those updated figures all came in higher, Andover would sit lower still in the broader views. (Columbia’s previously-stale 2017–2020 row is now resolved — the Wilson 2024–2028 contract supplies a current \$202,400 figure; the change shifts Columbia from below Andover to above-median.)

The FY 2026–27 proposal would move Andover from rank 21/21 to roughly rank 13/21 in the strict view against current peer rates — and that’s the important qualifier. The peer contracts shown are mostly FY 2025–26. Most of them will themselves step up in FY 2026–27. So while Andover’s FY27 number would substantially close the gap if peer pay stood still, peer pay won’t stand still, and the actual FY27-vs-FY27 picture will likely shift back toward the current gap. The +\$10K cash bump moves Andover from –14% below the current-cohort median to about –0.8% below it; whether it moves Andover closer to the FY27 median is a different question this report can’t yet answer.

The 403(b) bump from \$10K to \$15K is a structural change worth noting separately. The cash-component bump from \$90K → \$100K is what the FY26/FY27 budget document spotlights, but the 403(b) component is going up by half (50%) at the same time. Both are tax-advantaged compensation to the supe; both raise Andover’s total cost.

Only 6 peer districts remain pending — down from 22 two reports ago. Records requests to town clerks under CGS §10-244c have resolved the rest, including the entire six-district Region 1 cluster in a single contract (Brady-Shanley, served by the North Canaan clerk). The remaining six — Ashford, Mansfield/Storrs, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Union, Woodbridge — are the smallest of the EASTCONN-area districts plus two districts in transition (Mansfield’s new Morell contract not yet posted, Woodbridge K-6 supe being recruited). The missing rates could land above or below Andover’s; whether they do is genuinely unknown.

What this report does not show

- **Total compensation** including health insurance value, life insurance face amount, long-term disability, sick-day buyback, and IRS-rate mileage. These items vary widely across districts and a fair comparison would require valuing each district's specific health plan; the cash-only comparison sidesteps that.
- **Years of experience or tenure.** A first-year superintendent at \$200,000 is a different observation from a 20-year veteran at \$200,000. This report treats every contract uniformly regardless of the superintendent's experience.
- **Cost of living adjustments.** Fairfield County districts (Easton, Redding) have higher local costs than the eastern Connecticut towns that dominate the lower end of this distribution. The FTE-equivalent figures are nominal, not cost-of-living-adjusted.
- **Per-pupil or per-budget normalization.** A larger district legitimately needs a more senior superintendent, and some peers manage two or three times Andover's enrollment. This report normalizes by FTE, not by enrollment or budget size.
- **The missing peers.** The 6 districts where clerk outreach has not yet produced a current contract may have rates above or below the current cohort.
- **A causal claim about appropriateness.** This report describes where Andover sits in the peer distribution. It does not argue that being below median is good or bad, or that any particular pay rate is the "right" one. That is a judgment for residents.

DOCUMENTATION

Sources

Andover-specific documents

- **Andover Superintendent Contract 2023-2026** — [andoverelementaryct.org/.../2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf](https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (https://www.andoverelementaryct.org/images/forms/2023-2026_Superintendents_Contract.pdf) (scanned PDF, OCR'd)
- **Andover FY26/FY27 Town Budget** — approved at the February 11, 2026 Town Meeting; provides FY27 proposed figures

Peer-district contracts in the analysis (30) + 2 references

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In FTE-equivalent rank order. "Clerk §10-244c" sources were obtained directly from a town clerk in response to a records request.

- McKinnon (ER9 K-12: Easton, Redding) — direct PDF, 2024-2027
- White (Region 4 K-12: Centerbrook, Chester, Deep River) — clerk §10-244c (Chester), 2023-2026
- Sacharko (Barkhamsted K-6 + curr coord combined role, 0.385 supe-only FTE) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-2028
- Cosentino (Sherman K-8, part-time 0.4 FTE) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-2028
- Brady-Shanley (Region 1 K-12 joint: Falls Village, Kent, Lakeville, North Canaan, Sharon, West Cornwall) — clerk §10-244c (North Canaan), 2025-2028
- Scarpetti (Orange K-6) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-2028
- Byars (Amity Region 5 — reference HS-only contract for the regional 7-12 supe serving Bethany / Orange / Woodbridge) — user-supplied PDF, 2025-2028
- Baird (Hebron) — [hebron.k12.ct.us/.../GetFile.ashx](https://www.hebron.k12.ct.us/common/pages/GetFile.ashx?key=2CGfAbjf) (<https://www.hebron.k12.ct.us/common/pages/GetFile.ashx?key=2CGfAbjf>), 2025-2028
- Hageman (Marlborough K-6, TRB retiree 0.45 FTE) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-26
- Canelli (East Hartland / Hartland) — crawled, 2024-2027
- Wilson (Columbia K-6) — clerk §10-244c, 2024-2028
- Feder (Voluntown) — [voluntown.gov/.../Superintendent-PDF](https://www.voluntown.gov/DocumentCenter/View/489/Superintendent-PDF) (<https://www.voluntown.gov/DocumentCenter/View/489/Superintendent-PDF>), 2025-2026
- Hendrickson (Salem, part-time 0.7 FTE) — [salemschoolsorg/.../Supt_Contract.pdf](https://resources.finalsite.net/images/v1773319736/salemschoolsorg/n50ogiwunpu8wbrn55mt/Supt_Contract.pdf) (https://resources.finalsite.net/images/v1773319736/salemschoolsorg/n50ogiwunpu8wbrn55mt/Supt_Contract.pdf), 2024-2027
- Gilbert (Colebrook K-6, part-time 0.4 FTE) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-2028
- LePage (Region 7 HS-only — reference contract for the regional 7-12 supe serving Barkhamsted / Colebrook / New Hartford / Norfolk) — [newhartfordct.gov/.../reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf](https://www.newhartfordct.gov/sites/g/files/vyhli961/f/pages/reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf) (https://www.newhartfordct.gov/sites/g/files/vyhli961/f/pages/reg_7_superintendents_contract_2023-2026.pdf) 
- Sousa (New Hartford K-6) — clerk §10-244c, 2023-2026 (year-3 estimate)
- Zmary (Bozrah) — Google Drive copy supplied by district, 2025-2028
- Roche (Woodstock K-8) — clerk §10-244c, 2025-2028
- Luby (Winsted K-8) — clerk §10-244c, 2024-2027
- Raynor (Brooklyn) — crawled, 2024-2027
- Byrd (Bethany K-6) — clerk §10-244c, 2024-2027 (year-1 used as 2025-26 proxy)
- Seitsinger (Preston) — crawled, 2025-2028

- Skarzynski (Hampton K-8, part-time 0.3 FTE — separate from Chaplin joint) — clerk \$10-244c, 2025-2028
- Hull (Baltic K-8 / Sprague, TRB retiree 0.44 FTE) — clerk \$10-244c, 2024-2027
- Iacobelli (Norfolk) — crawled, 2022-2025 (year-3 figure used)
- Bruneau (Andover) — Andover scanned PDF OCR'd, 2023-2026
- Stevens (West Willington) — crawled, 2023-2026 [△](#)
- Rioux (Canterbury) — Canterbury CMS [media/3811](#) (<https://www.canterburyct.org/media/3811>), 2020-2023 [△](#)
- Leake (Eastford) — [eastfordct.org/.../Superintendent-Contract-2022.pdf](#) (<https://www.eastfordct.org/wp-content/uploads/2023/06/Superintendent-Contract-2022.pdf>), 2021-2024 [△](#)
- Bruneau (Scotland; separate contract from Andover's) — Scotland Town Clerk PDF at [municipal-documents.s3.amazonaws.com/.../Bruneau \(2\).pdf](#) (<https://municipal-documents.s3.amazonaws.com/uploads/scotland-ct/town-clerk/documents/generals/22580/Superintendent%20Contract%202021-2024%20Bruneau%20%28%29.pdf>), 2021-2024 [△](#)
- Skarzynski (Chaplin K-6 joint with Region 11 HS) — crawled, 2024-2027
- Friend (Sterling K-8) — clerk \$10-244c, 2026-2029 (future-dated proxy; excluded from latest-known views)

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Contracts received in this round (June 29, 2026 via clerk \$10-244c)

Eight contracts arrived after the previous report compilation, all in response to records requests routed through the clerks-tracker outreach app:

1. **Hageman (Marlborough K-6, 2025-26)** — TRB-retiree at 0.45 FTE (single-year contract); previously pending. Direct K-6 peer.
2. **Scarpetti (Orange K-6, 2025-2028)** — supersedes the prior \$185,230 floor inference from the Orange Administrators CBA; actual Scarpetti cash is meaningfully higher (\$244K conservative).
3. **Hull (Baltic / Sprague K-8, 2024-2027)** — TRB-retiree at 0.44 FTE. Direct K-8 peer.
4. **Friend (Sterling K-8, 2026-2029)** — future-dated; the 2025-26 supe is different and contract still outstanding. Sterling enters the dataset as a future-proxy only.
5. **Luby (Winsted K-8, 2024-2027)** — full-time K-8. Direct peer.
6. **Roche (Woodstock K-8, 2025-2028)** — full-time K-8. Direct peer.
7. **Sacharko (Barkhamsted K-6, 2025-2028)** — REFRESH: supe transition (Agostine retired/left; Sacharko started 11/1/2025). Combined supe + curriculum coordinator role; we measure only the supe portion (0.5 FTE = 0.385 of 260 days). Pushed Barkhamsted to rank 1 in V2 + V3.
8. **Wilson (Columbia K-6, 2024-2028)** — REFRESH: successor to the ancient Fearon 2017-2020 contract (the dataset's oldest entry). The Wilson 2025-26 figure (\$202,400) is **37% above** the Fearon stale figure, illustrating just how much stale-contract data can understate.

Pending — contract not located in public search (6)

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Only 6 peer districts remain pending. Two are in active transition; four are very small EASTCONN region districts where part-time supe arrangements are common.

In transition; contract not yet posted (2 districts):

- Mansfield/**Storrs** — Dr. Candace Morell, appointed at Special BoE meeting 5/21/2025, started 7/1/2025
- Woodbridge — K-6 supe unknown (new supe being recruited)

Contract not located, supe name not always established (4 districts):

Ashford, North Franklin (Franklin), Pomfret Center, Union.

Excluded

Norwich (too dissimilar in size and structure to be a useful peer).

Statutory basis

- CT Public Act 17-2 § 157 / CGS § 10-244c (requirement to post superintendent contracts on town websites)

Methodology and tooling

The full data pipeline, including the web scraper, OCR pipeline, comparison script, and `compensation.json` data file, lives in a separate working repository. The corrections log inside that data file documents the instances where automated attribution was wrong and was corrected by manual review — including, most notably, that an early Region 1 contract attribution turned out to be a New Canaan contract incorrectly hosted under a “/canaan” CMS subdomain, and that Salem’s contract had been read at 1.0 FTE before the contract text was verified to specify 28 hours per week (a 0.7 FTE adjustment).

Findings from an online research-agent collaboration (Connecticut town clerk contact research, regional district structure mapping, supe-tenure timelines) resolved several structural questions, most importantly that Region 1 operates under a single Joint Employment Agreement for one shared K-12 superintendent across all seven member boards — a finding that has now been confirmed by retrieving the actual Brady-Shanley contract (one contract resolved six pending peer districts).

A custom **town-clerk outreach app** (the “clerks tracker” at andoverct.info/clerks) was built between report compilations to manage §10-244c records requests at scale: it renders templated outreach emails per district, tracks reply status, holds received PDFs in a per-district uploads folder, and exports the entire dataset (manifest, JSON state, contracts) as a single zip. The seven contracts in the “Contracts received in this round” section above all came through that pipeline.

Auxiliary documents used to set salary floors and templates

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- **Orange Elementary Schools Administrators' Association CBA 2024-2027** — publicly posted at [orange-ct.gov/982/Board-of-Education-Contracts](https://www.orange-ct.gov/982/Board-of-Education-Contracts) (<https://www.orange-ct.gov/982/Board-of-Education-Contracts>). Article 10 establishes salary ranges for Orange's K-6 administrators; the Director of Special Services 2026-27 max (\$185,230) is a hard floor for Orange's superintendent compensation pending location of the supe's own contract.

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Other Formats

This report is available in three formats, all located alongside this page:



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Interactive version with formatted tables; best for on-screen reading and sharing.



Markdown

Plain-text version; readable in any editor, ideal for copying into other documents.



PDF

Print-ready version with all tables, footnotes, and source citations.